

Vidyasagar Veeramsetty

The Ladder Man of India

With a will as strong and tensile like aluminium, Vidyasagar Veeramsetty has carved out a leadership in an industry sector four decades ago, inspired many entrepreneurs leading with his example. Today, his multi-million-dollar company, Sagar Asia is acknowledged as **India's Number ONE** aluminium engineering company and recognized globally for a range of versatile aluminium products. 2023 marks the silver jubilee year of bringing ANSI (American Safety Standard Institutes) aluminium ladders and scaffolds through licenses, from global leader Werner Ladder Company, USA to India and Asian markets. It was Vidyasagar's vision of 1998 that brought aluminium access equipment centre stage in India.

Establishing a trading company, Vidyasagar Marketing Associates in 1983, Vidyasagar embarked on a journey of excellence, establishing his first aluminium extrusion plant in 1989 itself. The genesis of this enterprise dates back to 1979, when Vidyasagar, was working in a CA firm. Blending his dream, passion, and determination, this first-generation entrepreneur's vision has helped Sagar Asia evolve as the Numero Uno aluminium engineering company of India, paving the way for many companies to foray into this category. It has catalyzed the development of downstream products much ahead of time.



A former subsidiary of ZT Management Holding GmbH (held by Zarges, Germany and Tubasca, France) – a European major in aluminium engineering it was renamed as Sagar Asia Private Limited and was incorporated in India in 2007 as a joint venture company with Vidyasagar. The Indian venture was taken-over by Vidyasagar in 2010 to form Sagar Asia Private Limited. Vidyasagar had joint ventures, licenses and technical associations with seven global giants namely Werner (USA), Zarges(Germany), Tubasca(France), Little Giant(USA), Hailo Wind(Germany), Featherlite(Canada) and Nijl Aircraft Docking(Netherlands). In addition, the company has 4 Italian collaborations for aluminium architectural and furniture.

With over 40 years of category experience of the founder, Sagar Asia has emerged a leading manufacturer of Aluminium Extrusions and Aluminium products such as FRP Ladders, Scaffolds, Bridges, Platforms and Customised solutions, as well as Wind Tower Internals, Aviation Docking Systems, Architectural Systems, Solar Frames, Medical equipment and accessories with exports to USA, Europe,

Middle East, Egypt, China, Singapore, Japan and Malaysia. The products are import substitutes with huge export potential.

With the acquisition of the aluminium extrusion plant in 2016 from a Danish company – "Alumaco." Sagar Asia has built an integrated complex of manufacturing facilities with backward and forward integration to achieve cost reduction, better quality management and faster customer deliveries, facilitating supply-chain management. It is a unique model in the world for the product range and product conformance to world standards with an attached extrusion plant.

Sagar Asia, with its association of eight global giants in North America and Europe in the last twenty-five years, holds a strong pivotal position to transfer its technology-engineering and experience to developing and other African and Asian countries. Sagar Asia is second to none to scale its operations and spread its wings globally, to establish itself as one company with numerous products and brands.



In June 2023, Sagar Asia participated in the prestigious CII EXIM Bank Africa Meet and signed two crucial MOUS – NIJL Aircraft Docking of the Netherlands and the second one with Reroy Group Ltd (RGL), Ghana. The NIJL-Sagar Asia JV, including the value of technology, engineering and infrastructure, has an outlay of about Rs.100 crores and will bring a revenue of Rs.500 crores by exporting aviation docking systems globally.

This JV will enable the organization to contribute in India's Atmanirbhar initiatives and have its own world-class MROs which will give a further impetus to safe flying.



The JV Company formed between Sagar Asia and Reroy Group of Ghana will be catering to the territory of Africa and/or Indian and Global markets.

Sagar Asia Group is setting up a one-of-its-kind Aluminium Park in Telangana. Spread across 100 acres it will accommodate nearly 100 MSME units for downstream and other aluminium products for home consumption and export. The objective behind this park is to encourage local manufacturing capabilities, increase usage of locally produced raw-materials and improve manufacturing of value-added products which will not only attract foreign revenue, but also create lakhs of jobs for the Indian youth.

One of the most promising verticals focuses on wind – the energy of future. Sagar Asia's product range manufactures a gamut of hi-tech products for wind tower internals.

The company is certified for ISO 9001: 2015 along with OSHAS and ISO 14001 for Environment where all the products manufactured conform to stringent global standards.

Vidyasagar and his company have received many awards. The recognition started way back with best export award of aluminium products in 1995 by India's erstwhile FM Shri Manmohan Singh. From the Best Innovation and Best Supplier award to winning accolades for Health and Safety along with recognition by Swadeshi Jagran Manch and Laghu Udyog Bharti the company was also ranked 2nd position in the 2nd Edition of Pinnacle Awards for Excellence in Manufacturing by CII.

A true son of the soil, Mr. Vidyasagar has aligned Sagar Asia to the nation's vision of Make-in-India and Atma Nirbhar Bharat initiatives. His vision and spirit are shared by his sons - Agastya Sagar, Anand Sagar and Ananth Sagar and supported by a dedicated team of handpicked professionals, who are set to achieve many milestones realising a dream of a humble man and keeping it alive!

"Kitchen to skies, Sagar Asia has products and solutions for the universe", claims Vidyasagar. He says even the sky is not the limit for him.